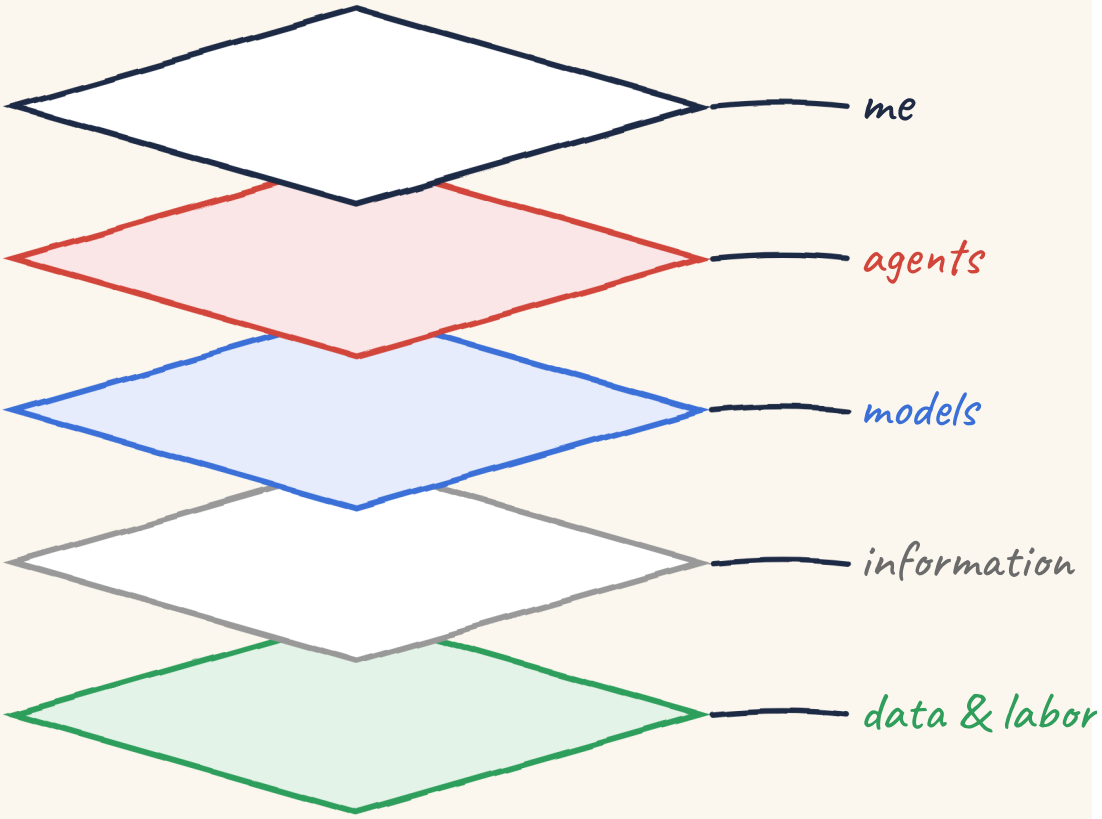


← binder clip (provided)

EXPERIMENTAL MIDTERM F26

CIXD 3110 · a zine about the tools that watch, learn & act

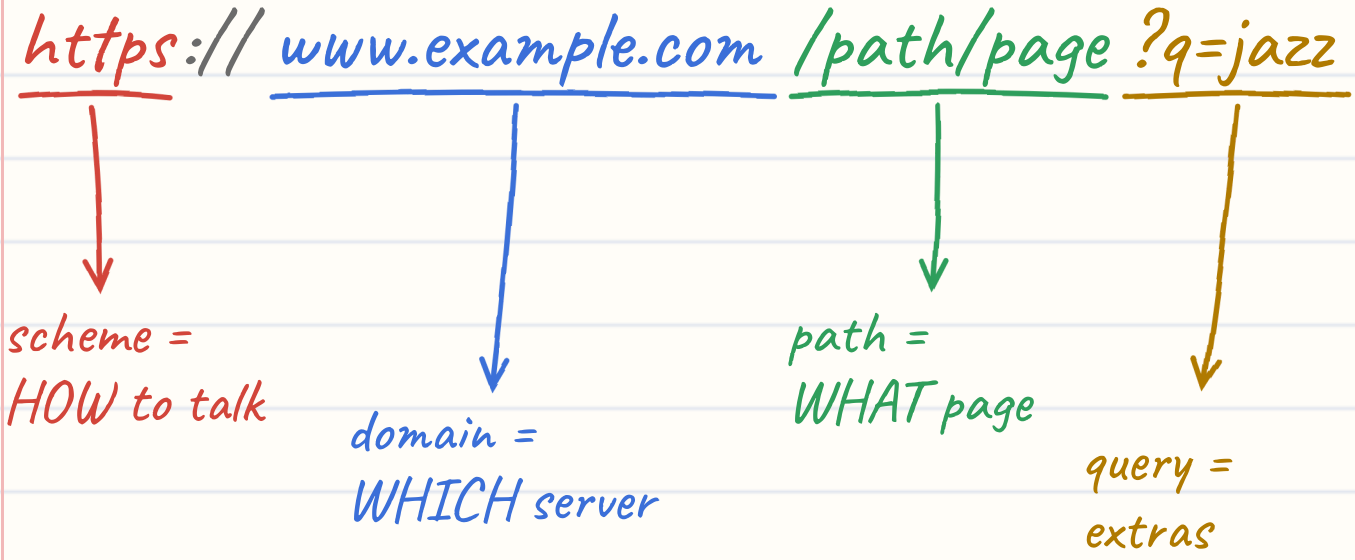


Name: _____

Section: 3110 / 6110

1.3 URL

Name the parts of a URL and say what each one tells the server.



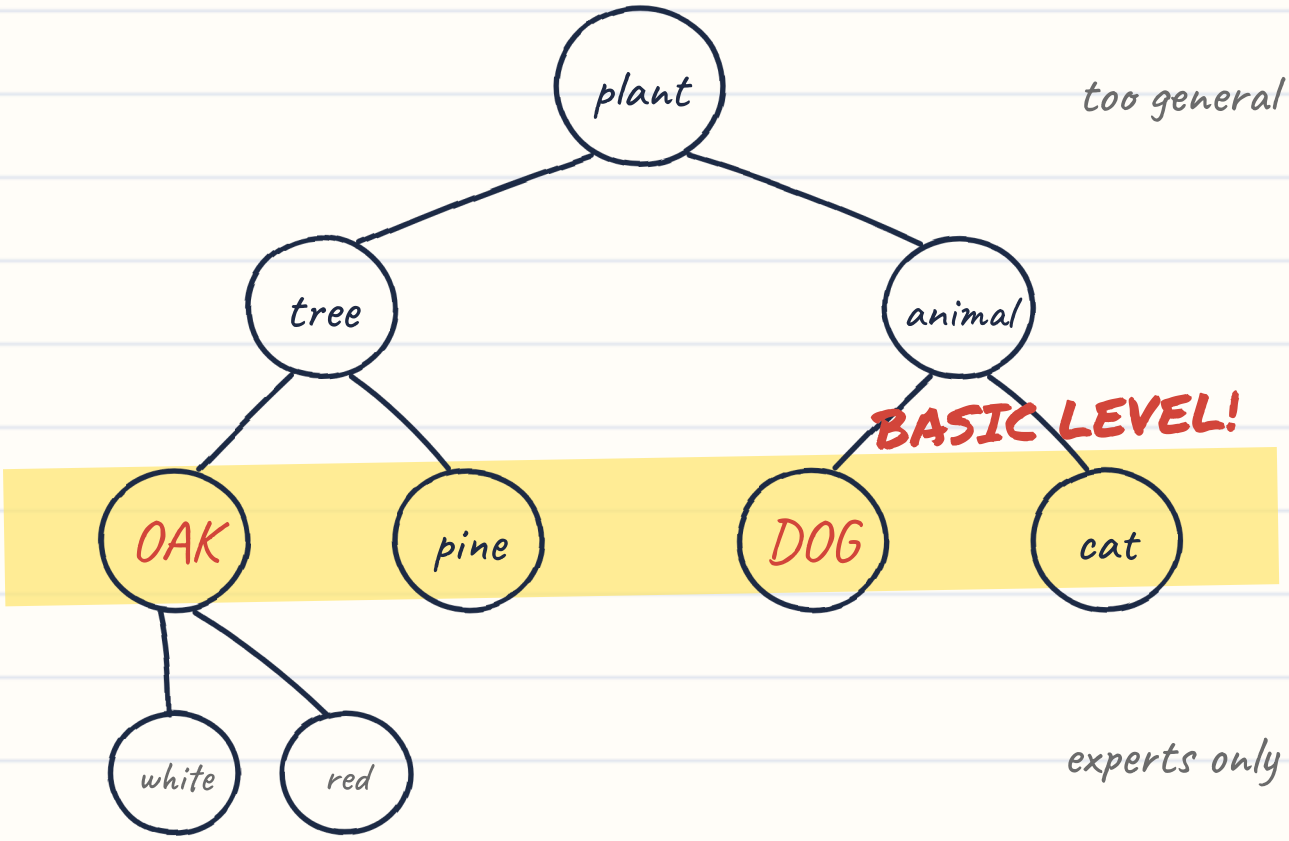
#top ← fragment: never sent to the server!

The URL is an address. Each part answers one question for the server: how, who, which door (port, usually hidden), what, and with which extras. (MDN)

TIP: the fragment stays in my browser

2.3 Folk taxonomy

What is a folk taxonomy, and why does the basic category (oak, dog) sit in the middle?

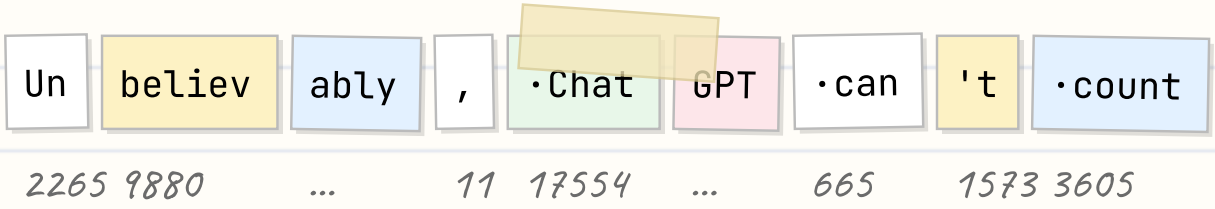


Folk taxonomy = the everyday way people name & group living things (Berlin: same ranks everywhere). The middle level is "basic" (Rosch): we see it, use it, learn it first, and it has the shortest names.

3.2 Token / tokenizer

What is a token, and why does the model see your sentence as tokens rather than words?

I cut my sentence with scissors:



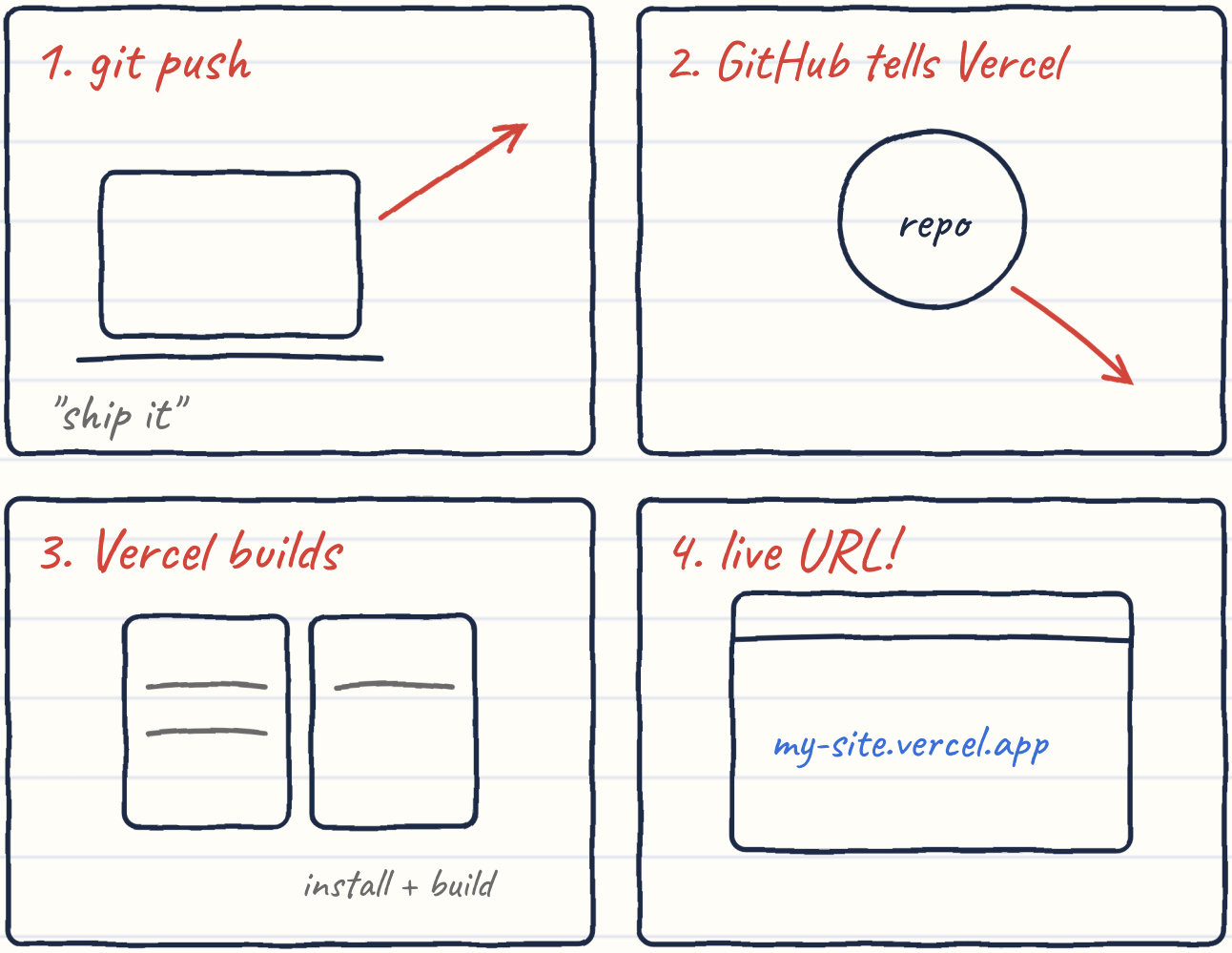
A token = a chunk of text (a word, part of a word, punctuation) that the tokenizer swaps for an ID number.

WHY: the model only does math on numbers, and a fixed vocabulary of chunks can spell ANY word, even new ones.

"strawberry" = 1 token so it can't count the r's!

4.3 Deployment

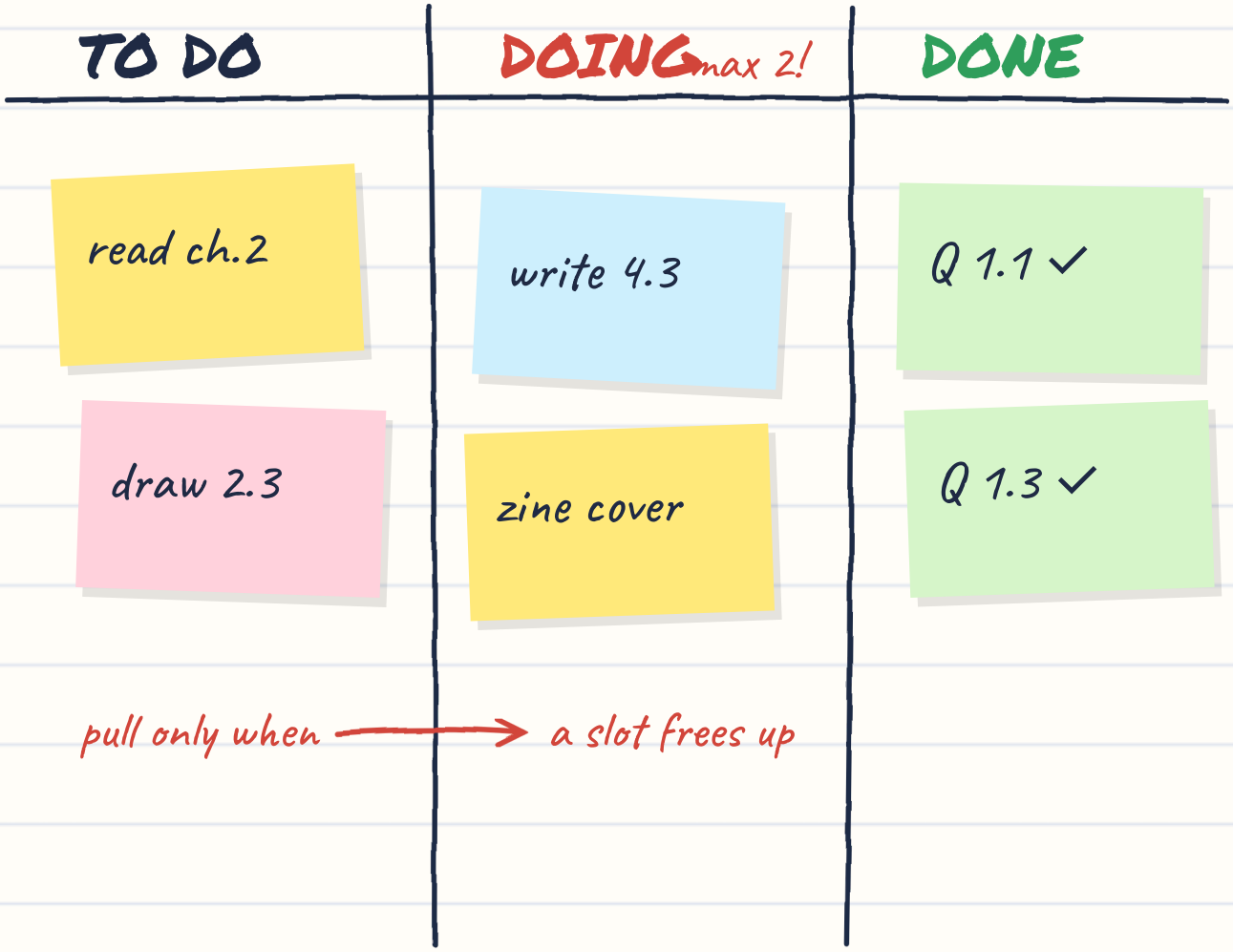
What happens between a push to GitHub and a page appearing on Vercel?



Push → GitHub stores the commit → a webhook tells Vercel → Vercel clones, builds, uploads to its CDN → points a URL at it. If the build fails, the old version stays live.

5.1 Kanban

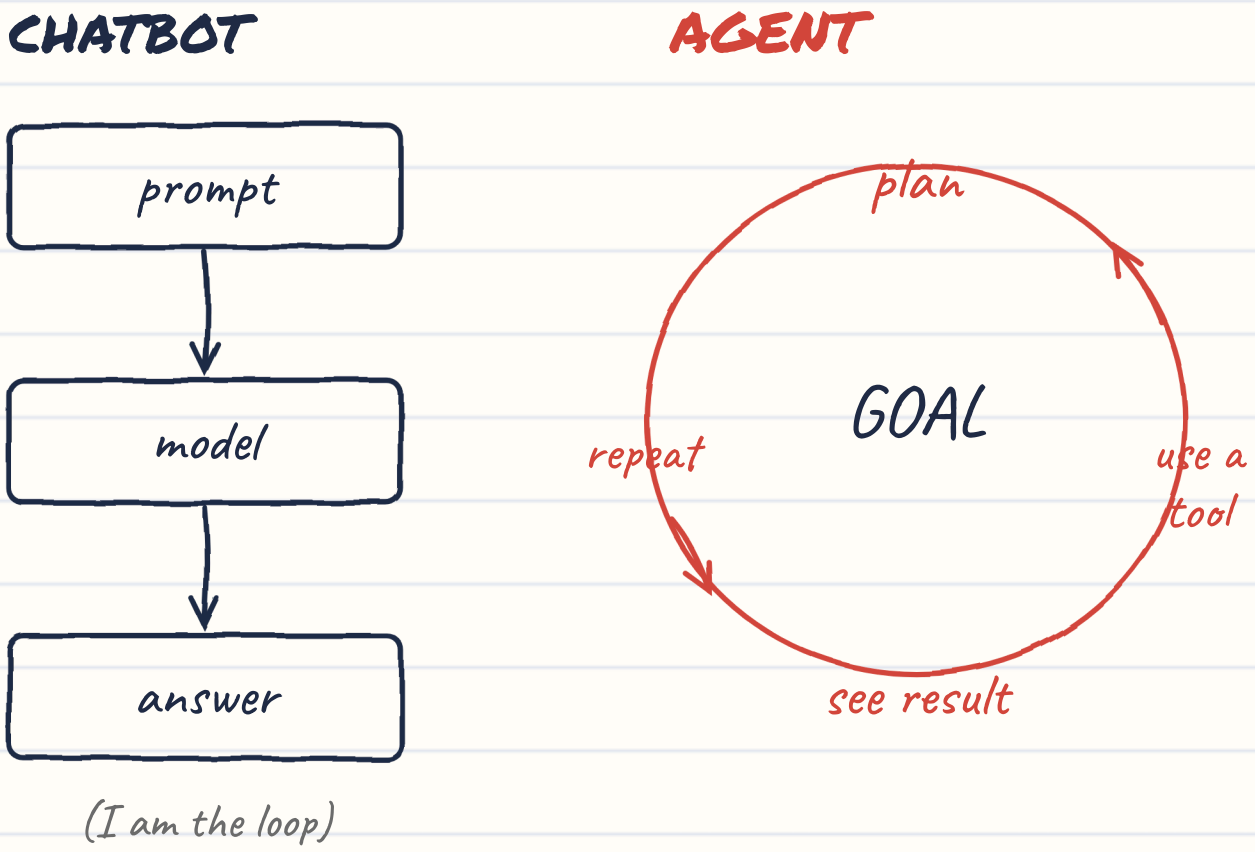
What is a Kanban board, and what can it track?



A board of cards in columns (states). It tracks work in progress: what's waiting, doing, done — and a WIP limit shows where work piles up.

6.1 Agent

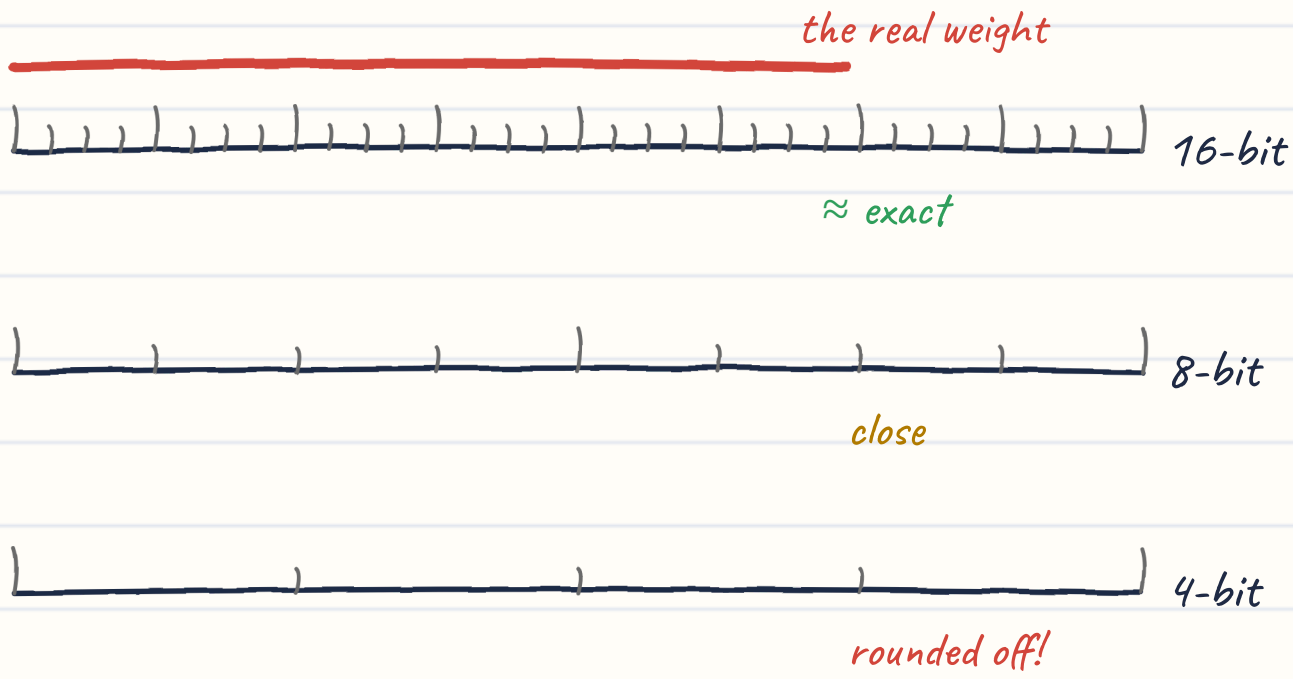
What makes a system an agent rather than a chatbot?



An agent runs in a LOOP: the model plans, calls tools, sees what really happened, and decides the next step until the goal is met (Anthropic). A chatbot just answers once.

7.3 Quantization

What is quantization, and what do you gain and lose by running a smaller version of a model?



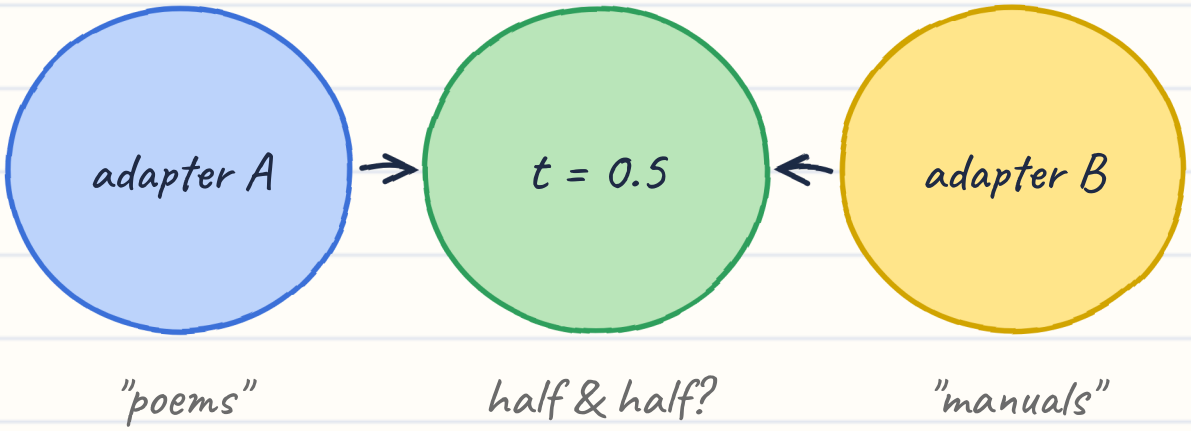
Quantization = storing each weight with fewer bits, so every number gets rounded.

GAIN: smaller file, fits in RAM, faster

LOSE: a bit less precise / accurate

8.5 Merge / blend

What happens when two adapters are blended at t = 0.5, and who wrote the result?



$$W = (1-T)\cdot A + T\cdot B$$

Every weight becomes the average of the two adapters — a mix of both styles (or mush). WHO WROTE IT? Nobody directly: the two datasets' authors, the base model's makers, and the person who picked t.

9.1 When the guidelines apply

Choose one guideline from each group and say what it asks of the designer. (Amershi et al.)

INITIALLY

G1 Make clear what it can do

→ show the menu!

✓

DURING

G4 Show info that fits the moment

→ maps: next turn

✓

WHEN WRONG

G9 Easy to correct

→ undo / edit autocorrect ✓

✓

OVER TIME

G17 Global controls

→ one switch to turn it all off

✗

Each guideline asks the designer to plan for one moment of using AI — not just the moment it works.

C5 What would you do with it

Where in your practice do these technologies resonate the most? Positive and negative.



← YOUR words here!
(this is only a model)

BEFORE I CLIP IT:

- [x] every question answered (no blanks!)
- [x] definitions as the SOURCES say them
- [x] source named (Wright, Zuboff, MDN…)
- [x] in MY own words, not copied
- [x] one drawing / collage per class
- [x] name + section on the cover
- [x] pages in order, binder clip on

due Fri Nov 20 · 5 pm

+5 points for the zine version